

Zan Baldwin

Senior PHP/Symfony engineer with 16 years of production experience, from software supply chain infrastructure at Packagist to healthcare compliance, fintech regulation, and high-traffic event platforms. Proven background in scalable API design, security-sensitive systems, and open-source community leadership.

International work history spanning 5 countries.

+31 6 38865043

hello@zanbaldwin.com

STRENGTHS

- **Certifications and Regulations**

Experience with certifications and industry regulations (such as PCI-DSS, GDPR and ISO 27001).

- **Leadership & Mentoring**

Technical and keynote speaker for multiple [Symfony conferences](#). Technical speaker, CfP selection committee member, and panellist speaker for [Dutch PHP Conference](#). Mentoring junior developers, advocating for [Diversity & Inclusion](#), and [incident response training](#) within the tech industry. Outside of tech I organise meetups and am a member of a UK charity's committee board.

- **Open Source Contributor**

Active code and docs contributor to open-source projects and [personal libraries](#), as well as “soft” contributions such as Code of Conducts, team coordination and moderation.

EXPERIENCE

WeDevelop, Senior Symfony Engineer

DECEMBER 2023–PRESENT · APELDOORN, NETHERLANDS
PHP/Symfony · API Design · Documentation, Architecture and Guidelines

- Led all backend development for a course registration platform handling enrolments, payments, and administration — processing approximately 500 applicants and €250K in revenue in the first 6 months.
- Built a data aggregation API caching ~250K monthly inventory and pricing changes from Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central, reducing upstream API load and providing reliable endpoints for downstream consumers.
- Translated ambiguous client requirements into actionable technical specifications, bridging the gap between non-technical stakeholders and development teams.
- Introduced containerised development environments and advocated for API design standards and code review practices across the team.

SKILLS OVERVIEW

- Software Architecture
- Design Patterns
- Relational Databases
- Containerization/Docker
- NoSQL/Graph Data Stores
- Documentation Writing
- API Design & OpenAPI
- Linux System Admin
- Cloud Providers
- Unit & Behavioural Testing; Debugging
- Automation

Primary (PHP): v8+ · Composer
Symfony 7 & 8 · Doctrine · Twig · DDD
TDD/BDD · Static Analysis · SOLID
REST · HATEOAS

Data: Redis · AMQP · Elasticsearch
Postgres/MySQL/SQLite · MongoDB

Infrastructure: Linux · SystemD
Docker/Podman · CI/CD · AWS
TLS/SSL · shell scripting

Also: Rust/Cargo · FFI · Git
OpenAPI · OAuth · Agile
Code Review Best Practices

LANGUAGE English (native),
Dutch (beginner).

Packagist, Senior Software Engineer

 MARCH 2022–DECEMBER 2023 · BERLIN (REMOTE)

PHP/Symfony · Platform Engineering · Code Hosting & Distribution

- Maintained and extended Private Packagist, the commercial arm of the PHP ecosystem's central package registry, serving as critical software infrastructure.
- Contributed to PHP software supply chain security by building Composer audit API endpoints and integrating security advisory tracking into the package distribution pipeline.
- Designed and built security-sensitive features including multi-factor authentication, organisational token management, and audit logging across the entire platform — systems where correctness and data integrity were non-negotiable.
- Built a comprehensive Team Management API from specification to implementation: OpenAPI design, permissions model, extensive unit and integration test coverage.

- Identified and resolved race conditions in package synchronisation and entity persistence, improving reliability of concurrent operations across the platform.
- Created the project's containerised development environment from scratch, standardising onboarding and replacing fragile manual setup across the team.

SmarterQueue, Symfony Developer 2020–2022 · VANCOUVER → NETHERLANDS (REMOTE)

PHP/Symfony · GraphQL · Social Media · Third-party APIs · Docker

Principal backend developer for overhauling a legacy product into a modern, GraphQL-backed application.

- Designed the application architecture for a ground-up rebuild of a legacy application: domain modelling, service boundaries, and data layer design for a GraphQL-backed platform.
- Improved both speed and memory performance of the legacy product up to 50 times via application profiling.
- Maintained a 100% test coverage rate for an entire GraphQL API for both functional and unit tests.

Intergalactic Agency, Lead PHP Developer 2019–2020 · VANCOUVER, CANADA

PHP/Symfony · OpenAPI · DevOps & Docker · Deployment Strategies

Lead PHP developer for in-house and client projects, both new and legacy, including: BC Liquor, Mental Health Commission Canada, Palo Alto, Eventbase, Sundance Film Festival.

- Increased resilience of the company assets spread across multiple continents, upgraded internal source control, and added automated upgrades and backups.
- Decreased company expenses and increased developer productivity by obsoleting old manual processes, replacing with automated CI/CD and containerized deployment.
- Achieved 100% reliability for high-traffic projects for physical events/conferences using fewer servers, improving Intergalactic's reputation and earning repeat business from clients.

CarePlanner Ltd, Senior Software Developer 2018–2019 · BRISTOL, ENGLAND

PHP/Symfony · RESTful APIs · SaaS · Data Protection · GDPR

A leading role spearheading a project to build a RESTful API platform from the ground up for a rapidly-growing SaaS provider in the Home Care sector.

- Reduced organisation's risk while storing/handling health and medical data of vulnerable individuals by ensuring strict compliance of ISO 27001 & GDPR within the developer teams.
- Consolidated market share for the organisation by building APIs that brought two external companies and a local government authority to collaborate with CarePlanner rather than compete.
- Coached a Drupal 7 development team of 3 on Symfony framework from scratch.

BaseKit Platform, Software Engineer 2015–2018 · BRISTOL, ENGLAND

PHP/Symfony · B2B · DevOps & Docker · Sysadmin · WHMCS · Behat

Worked on the backend of a global B2B site-building SaaS platform and its supporting projects.

- Kept a multi-million line codebase up to date, or rewrote several legacy parts, to transition the application from PHP 5.x to 7.
- Ensured that builds could be reliably deployed with confidence by adding significant behavioural test case coverage on top of the existing unit tests within the CI pipeline.

Nosco Systems, Lead Technical Developer 2012–2015 · PONTYPRIDD, WALES

PHP · Yii · Raspberry Pi · Fintech · Legal & Regulation · Sysadmin · Mentorship

Developer for a cloud-based digital debt and loan management application, and supporting software/hardware.

- Kept the software ahead of constantly changing legal and regulatory changes within the industry.
- Handled deployments of software for both cloud-based servers and in-store shop kiosks, with bottom-line accountability for the company's infrastructure.
- Led and mentored teams of developers both in-house and remote (Bulgaria), including travelling to provide training.

(2 more positions between 2010–2012)

PROJECTS

darsyn/ip PHP library · [repo](#) · [package stats](#)

Author and maintainer since 2015 (six major versions, 2M+ installs, ~34k/month) of an immutable IP address value-object library with a separate Doctrine integration. Implements 128-bit IPv6/CIDR arithmetic as dependency-free byte-string operations, pluggable IPv4-in-IPv6 embedding strategies (mapped, 6to4, Teredo, NAT64), and address classification aligned with the IANA special-purpose registries. One codebase, tested across ten PHP runtimes (7.1-8.5) and verified by ~5k tests, under strict SemVer and static analysis.

zanbaldwin/atshield Rust library and CLI application · [repo](#)

Designer and sole author of a tamper-detection tool for AT Protocol (Bluesky) decentralised identities, re-verifying every did:plc operation from scratch: every CID recomputed from canonical DAG-CBOR, every ECDSA signature re-checked (secp256k1/P-256, strict low-S), DID re-derived from genesis bytes. Attributes every change to its signing key: the same operation is legitimate when signed by a key the user holds, tampering if signed by anyone else. Tested against the protocol's official test vectors and captured histories, including forks, tombstones, and legacy operations.

zanbaldwin/rawr Rust CLI tool · [repo](#)

A personal, offline-only archival tool that organises a library of downloaded web fiction: cataloguing each copy, tracking successive versions, and rendering works to PDF for e-readers (Kindle, reMarkable). Web-published works are subject to silent revision or deletion by their authors; saved copies are often the only durable record. An 11-crate Cargo workspace with content-addressed storage (BLAKE3), ephemeral SQLite database rebuildable from archive files, pluggable storage backends (local/S3), streaming file processing that never loads a file whole, and compile-time state-machine enforcement via the `typestate` pattern.

Passion project under continuous rolling development; distributed as source, not as packaged releases.